Congress party, Y.S. Mahajan and Saminud-din, landed in Kabul on 24 December to meet President Karmal. The Afghans were apprehensive of a meeting between Indira and Zia and had cautioned the Indians about Pakistan's unreliability. On the other hand, Zia worried that the Soviets and India were conspiring to break Pakistan into several states including Pakhtoonistan, Balochistan, Sind and Punjab and therefore allowed his country to be used as a supply base and sanctuary for terrorists.

Meanwhile, a R&AW operative Ved Asthana, who had established contact with Massoud at Panjshir in northern Afghanistan in 1983, had advised him to enter into a temporary truce with the Soviets. Massoud was also warned against Jamaat-e-Islami leader Rabbani, who the R&AW insisted was playing by Pakistan's rules. He was advised to mobilise the local commanders under a new council outside the influence of insurgent groups operating from Pakistan, and while admitting Rabbani's treachery, he promised to rebuild the units under his command.

Ashfaq said Indian intelligence provided Massoud with some financial support but that was not enough. He maintained his army of five thousand guerrillas with his own resources and was able to capture several northern provinces over the next few years, defeating the combined forces of the Soviet and Afghan armies. By the end of 1983, Ashfaq said, the resistance powered by American arms had become a formidable force against the Soviets. According to Indian intelligence estimates, the Afghan government backed by Soviet troops was in control only of about thirty per cent of the region.